

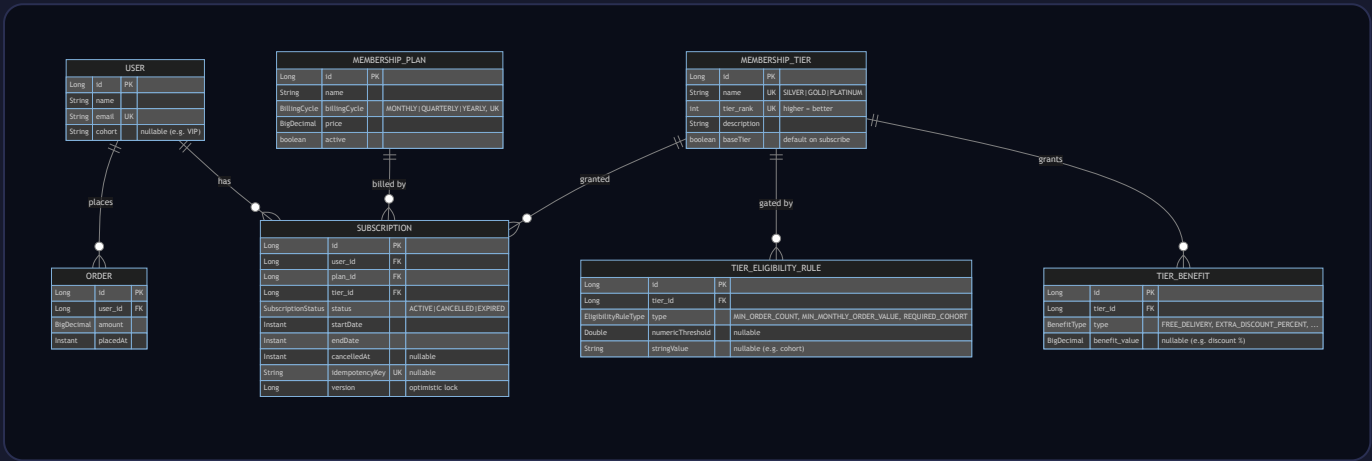
# Entity Design — FirstClub Membership Program

Normalised, data-driven model. Tiers, benefits and promotion rules are rows, not code — fully configurable.

[➤ Demo console](#)   [➤ Architecture & flow](#)   [ER diagram](#)   [Entity reference](#)   [Design rationale](#)

## 1 • Entity-relationship diagram

A subscription binds a **user** to a **plan** and a **tier**. A tier owns many configurable **benefits** and **eligibility rules**. **Orders** feed tier evaluation.



## 2 • Entity reference

| Entity              | Responsibility              | Key design points                                                                                                       |
|---------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| User                | Platform member             | <code>cohort</code> drives cohort-based eligibility; email unique.                                                      |
| MembershipPlan      | Billing cadence + price     | <code>BillingCycle</code> enum carries duration months → expiry math. One plan per cycle.                               |
| MembershipTier      | A tier & its perks/gates    | <code>rank</code> orders tiers for upgrade/downgrade; <code>baseTier</code> = default. Owns benefits + rules (cascade). |
| TierBenefit         | One configurable perk       | Stored as rows (not flags) → add/remove/retune perks at runtime.                                                        |
| TierEligibilityRule | One promotion criterion     | Maps to a Strategy by <code>type</code> ; ALL rules of a tier must pass.                                                |
| Subscription        | User↔Plan↔Tier for a window | <code>@Version</code> optimistic lock; unique <code>idempotencyKey</code> ; lazy expiry.                                |
| Order               | A purchase                  | Raw signal for order-count & monthly-spend rules.                                                                       |

## 3 • Design rationale (abstractions, extensibility, modularity)

| Decision                                                                         | Why                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Benefits & rules as <b>child rows</b> , not boolean columns                      | New perks/criteria need no schema or code change — the program is configured as data and editable via APIs. |
| Plan and Tier are <b>separate</b> entities                                       | Orthogonal concerns: billing cadence vs. benefit level. A user keeps their plan while moving tiers.         |
| <b>Enums</b> for cycle / benefit / rule / status                                 | Type-safety + each enum constant pairs with a strategy or duration, keeping behaviour close to data.        |
| <code>tier_rank</code> as an integer                                             | Single source of truth for ordering → trivial, correct upgrade/downgrade comparisons.                       |
| <b>Version</b> + idempotency on Subscription                                     | Concurrency-safe lifecycle without pessimistic DB locks (see Architecture §5).                              |
| Reserved words mapped<br>( <code>tier_rank</code> , <code>benefit_value</code> ) | Portable across H2 / other SQL engines.                                                                     |